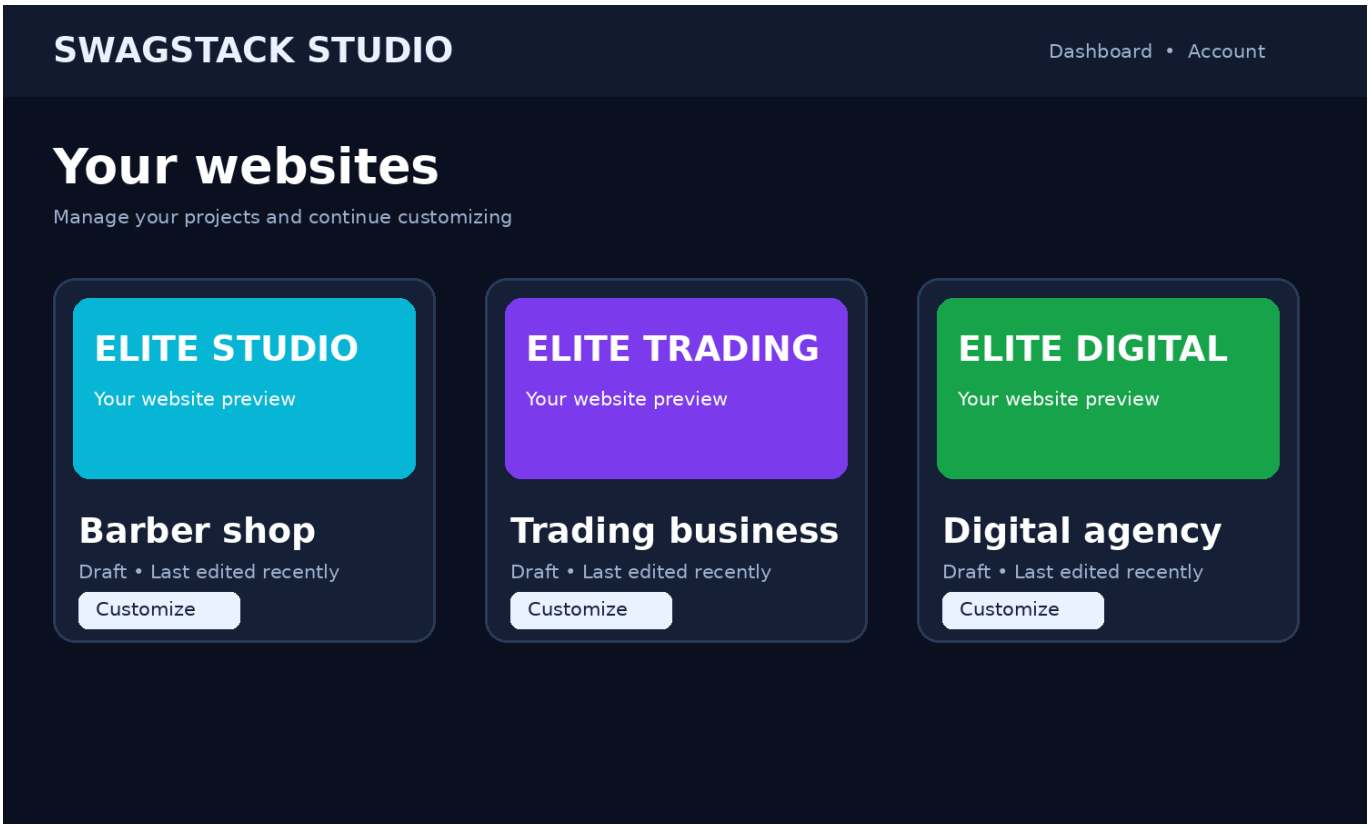
SWAGSTACK

Website Customizer Platform

Concept proposal • Customer experience • Feature plan • Implementation direction



A platform where customers log in, choose a professionally designed website template, customize the available options, and publish their own website — without needing to code.

Prepared as a concept document for planning and development.

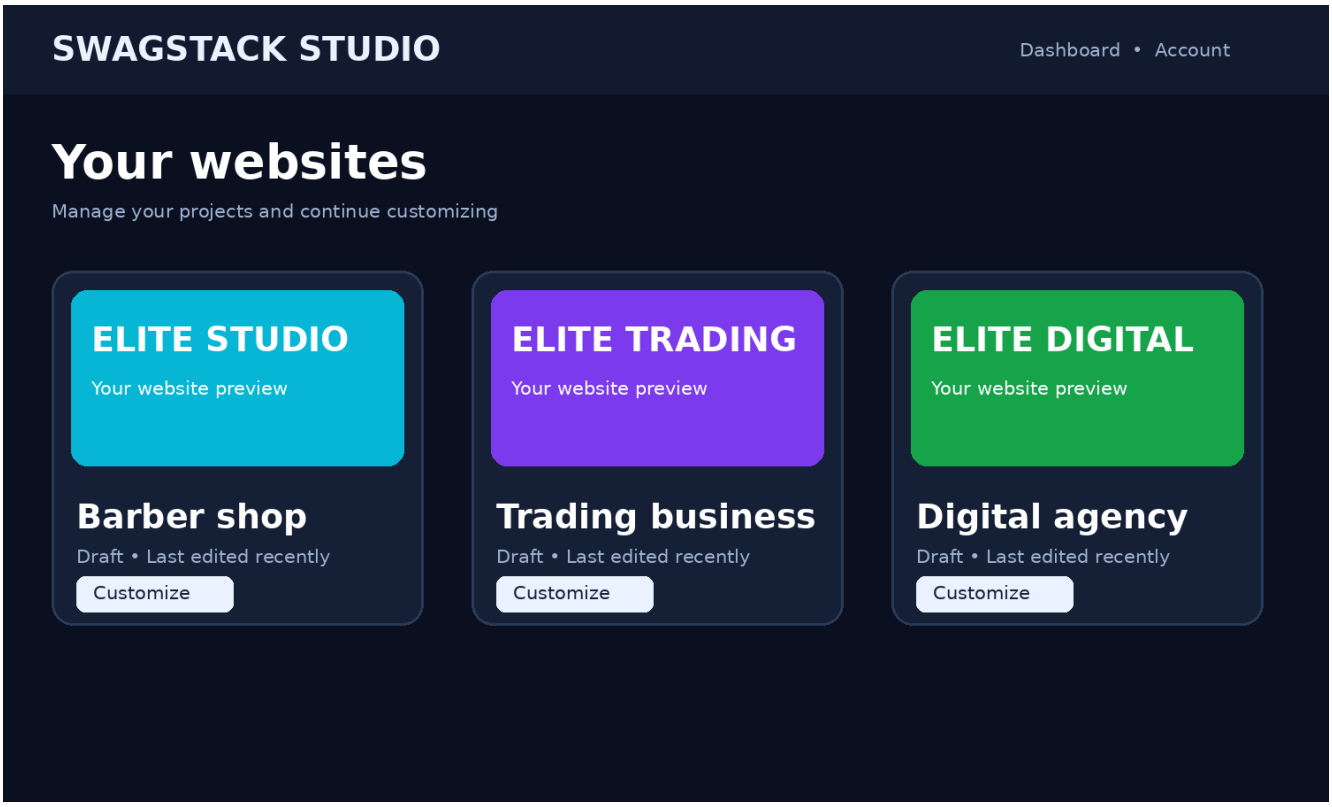
1. The idea

SwagStack Website Customizer is a web-based platform that lets the business create and manage reusable website templates. Customers create accounts, select a template, customize the fields and sections made available to them, preview their changes, and publish their website.

The main benefit is scale: instead of manually building every customer website from scratch, SwagStack builds the underlying platform and template library once, then gives each customer a controlled self-service editor.

Core customer journey

Step	What happens
1. Templates	SwagStack creates ready-made templates for different business types.
2. Account	Customer signs up or logs in and accesses their dashboard.
3. Choose	Customer selects a template, such as a barber shop, restaurant, trading business or digital agency.
4. Customize	Customer edits approved fields such as text, images, logo, colors, prices, services and links.
5. Preview	Customer previews desktop and mobile layouts before publishing.
6. Publish	Customer publishes to a platform subdomain or connects a custom domain, depending on the selected plan.



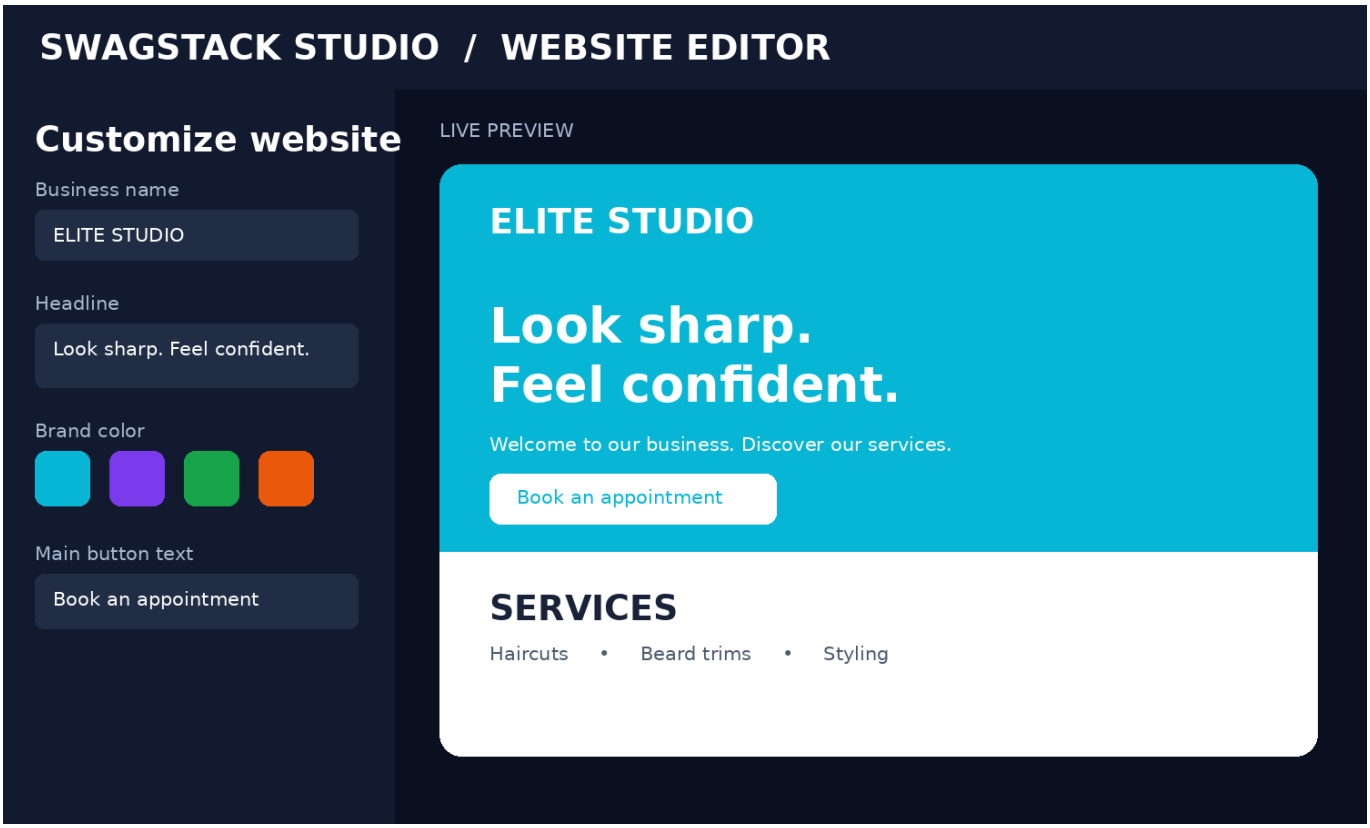
Concept visual: customer dashboard with multiple websites and a Customize action.

2. Customer editor experience

The editor should be simple enough for a customer to use without technical knowledge. The customer changes values in a settings panel while seeing a live preview of the website.

Suggested customizable fields

- Business name and logo
- Headline, paragraph text and about section
- Brand colors and selected fonts
- Hero image, gallery images and videos where supported
- Services, products, prices and descriptions
- Phone number, email, WhatsApp link and social links
- Main call-to-action button text and destination URL
- Section visibility and ordering, where the template permits it
- SEO title, meta description and social sharing image
- Desktop and mobile preview



Concept visual: left-side editing controls and a right-side live preview. This image is illustrative, not a functioning application.

Template controls

Each template should define which parts are editable. For example, a customer can change the words, images and colors without accidentally breaking the layout. More advanced freedom — such as moving elements or creating new sections — can be added later as a drag-and-drop mode.

3. Template library

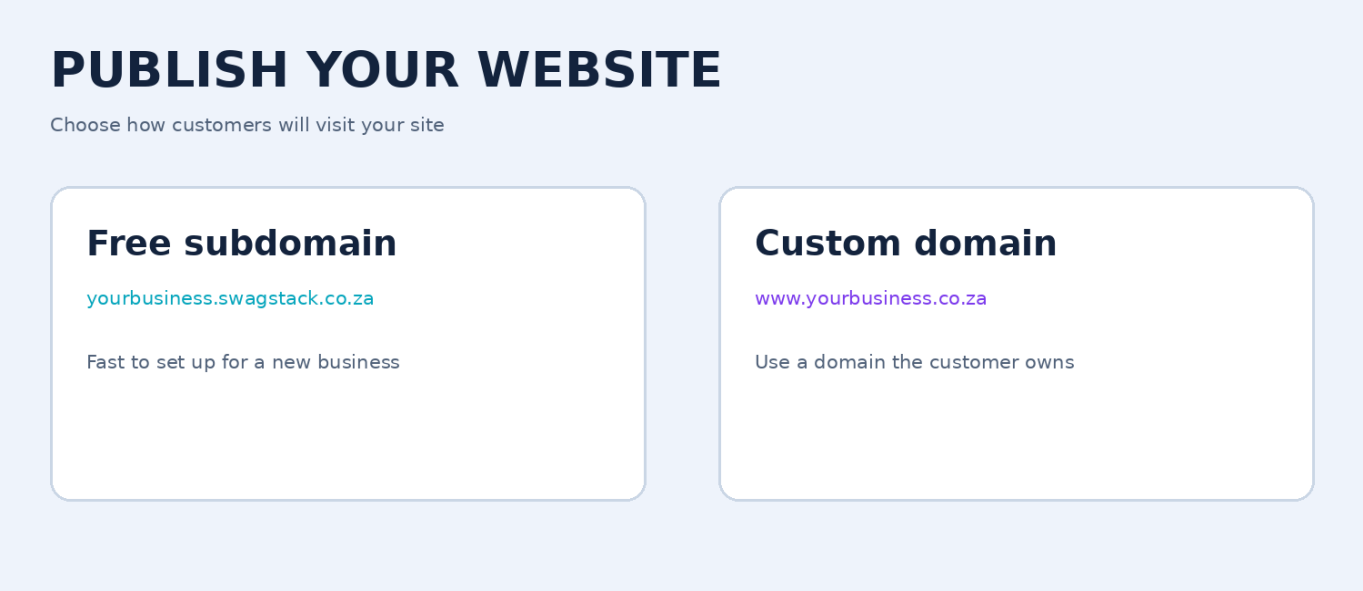
Initial template categories

- Barber shops and salons
- Restaurants and takeaways
- Traders and trading education businesses
- Digital agencies and software companies
- Personal portfolios and creator pages
- Local service businesses

Each template should have a preview image, category, short description, supported sections, and an indication of whether it is available on the customer's plan.

4. Publishing and domains

The platform needs a publishing service that turns a customer's saved configuration into a live website. The initial version can use platform subdomains. Custom domain connection can be added either in the first release or as a later feature.



Possible publishing options

- Platform subdomain: for example, yourbusiness.swagstack.co.za, subject to domain and DNS setup.
- Custom domain: for example, www.yourbusiness.co.za, owned or purchased by the customer.
- Draft and publish states: customers can save changes without immediately changing the live site.
- SSL/HTTPS, responsive output, backups and error handling should be included in the publishing design.

Important: the example addresses above are illustrative. Actual domain availability and technical configuration must be verified during implementation.

5. Customer and admin features

Customer dashboard

- Sign up, log in, reset password and manage profile
- View all owned websites and each website’s status
- Create a website from an available template
- Edit, preview, save, publish and unpublish
- Manage images and business information
- See plan status, usage limits and billing history

Super-admin dashboard

- Manage customers, accounts, roles and access
- Create, edit, duplicate, publish and retire templates
- Define editable fields and locked design elements per template
- Review published websites and suspend abusive content
- Manage plans, payments, quotas and usage
- Monitor storage, domains, publishing errors and platform activity
- Manage support requests and audit logs

Security and reliability

- Customers must only be able to edit websites they own or have permission to manage.
- Validate uploaded files, restrict file types and sizes, and prevent unsafe script injection.
- Keep secrets and API keys on the server, never in public browser code.
- Use database access rules and server-side authorization for every protected action.
- Keep backups and provide a recovery path for deleted or broken websites.
- Log important admin actions and protect account recovery flows.

6. Monetization options

Three business models are possible. The final pricing should be decided after estimating hosting, storage, domain, support and payment-provider costs.

Model	How it works	Considerations
Once-off	Customer pays once to access and publish.	Define who pays ongoing hosting and renewal costs.
Monthly subscription	Customer pays while the website remains hosted and editable.	Recurring revenue; define what happens when a plan expires.
Setup + monthly	Charge a setup fee plus recurring hosting/editor access.	Can cover onboarding while funding ongoing infrastructure.

7. Recommended technical direction

A practical architecture for development in Cursor

• Front end: a modern React-based framework such as Next.js, with reusable template components and a responsive editor UI.
• Authentication: a secure managed authentication provider, or the existing project's authentication if it meets security requirements.
• Database: store users, websites, template versions, website configuration, plans, domains and publishing state.
• File storage: store uploaded logos and media in object storage with access controls.
• Rendering: each published site is generated from an approved template and the customer's validated configuration.
• Hosting: deploy the editor/admin application and design a separate publishing flow for customer websites.
• Payments: integrate a provider that explicitly supports the business model and digital services, after account approval and terms review.
• Monitoring: track usage, failures, performance, storage and billing events.

Suggested data model

Users • Websites • Templates • TemplateVersions • WebsiteConfigurations • MediaAssets • Domains • Plans • Subscriptions • Payments • UsageRecords • AuditLogs

A key technical decision is to store customer changes as structured configuration data, rather than letting each customer freely edit the underlying application code. This makes websites safer, easier to maintain and easier to update when templates improve.

8. Build roadmap

Phase	Deliverable
Phase 1 — Foundation	Authentication, customer dashboard, admin roles, database schema and template library.
Phase 2 — Editor	Editable fields, media uploads, color controls, live preview, autosave and mobile preview.
Phase 3 — Publishing	Draft/published states, subdomains, HTTPS and website rendering.
Phase 4 — Business model	Plans, payment integration, usage limits, expiry handling and billing history.
Phase 5 — Expansion	Custom domains, more templates, section ordering, analytics and drag-and-drop editing.

9. Recommended first release

Start with customizable templates rather than a full free-form drag-and-drop editor. This gets the core product into use sooner and reduces complexity. The first release should allow a customer to log in, create one website from a template, change approved fields, preview it, save it, and publish it to a platform subdomain.

After the core flow is reliable, add billing and custom domains if they are not already part of the first release. Add drag-and-drop only when there is a clear customer need and the template system is stable.

10. Decisions to confirm

Before implementation begins, confirm:

1. Editor type: controlled template customization or full drag-and-drop.
2. Publishing: subdomains, custom domains, or both.
3. Pricing: once-off, monthly, or setup fee plus monthly.
4. Whether the project already has a preferred framework, database, authentication and hosting setup.
5. Which template category should be built first.

This document is a product concept and implementation plan. Visuals are original illustrative mockups; they are not screenshots of a finished product. Pricing, infrastructure and domain examples are placeholders to validate during development.